

PURPOSE: To define the looser dress code that is enforced on non-academic days.

INTRODUCED BY: Senator Marquez

**BE IT RESOLVED BY THE MISSISSIPPI SCHOOL FOR MATHEMATICS AND
SCIENCE**

SECTION ONE (DEFINITIONS):

Academic days: days Monday through Friday when classes are in session.

Non-academic days: days Saturday, Sunday, and days when classes are not in session.

SECTION TWO (REASONING):

The Dress and Grooming section of the handbook insists that the dress code is needed to uphold an environment that prioritizes learning and to prevent any disruptions to education. If this is the case, then it is completely unnecessary for dress code to be strictly enforced on the weekend or non-academic days. There are no classes taking place and students are not in any of the academic buildings, therefore no disturbances are created by what a student chooses to wear. Further, students should not have to worry about receiving trivial referrals on their days of leisure.

I have heard various complaints, mainly from Goen residents, about being dress coded and issued referrals on weekends. At the beginning of the year, we were told that the dress code is more loosely enforced on the weekends and non-academic days, so this bill defines the regulations that will still be in place. I believe that this will clear up confusion about dress code standards on non-academic days, saving students from avoidable referrals.

When writing the looser dress code, I consulted with peers, Goen staff, and a previous bill which cites the dress codes of other magnet schools similar to MSMS. Even on non-academic days, administration will still have the final authority on dress code.

SECTION THREE (SPECIFIC CHANGE):

On pages 30 and 31 of the Student Handbook (pdf pages 35 and 36), the following will be changed:

DRESS AND GROOMING

Dress and grooming standards are established to ensure that the school climate reflects, safety, appropriateness, and a serious focus on learning. We recognize that fashions, styles, and trends evolve; therefore, the school reserves authority in matters which may arise and are not identified within this policy. MSMS staff reserves the right to request students to return to their residence hall to change if attire is deemed inappropriate or potentially disruptive to the educational process. Both Residential Life and Academic Affairs shall enforce this policy. The final authority regarding proper dress and grooming shall be the MSMS Administration.

The following standards must be followed ~~AT ALL TIMES~~ during academic days:

- 1) Appropriate undergarments must be worn and should not be visible; and students should not go shirtless;
- 2) Footwear must be worn when outside the residence hall room;
- 3) Clothing may not contain slogans or images which are considered profane or vulgar, or promote tobacco products, alcohol, drugs, or gang affiliation, or considered insensitive to race, religion, sexual orientation, ethnicity or gender;
- 4) Leggings that are see-through or with mesh inserts, clothing considered sleepwear/loungewear, and pajama jeans may not be worn outside the residence halls or in the 1st floor lobby of the residence halls;
- 5) Clothing must provide adequate covering:
 - a. Skirts, dresses, shorts, or similar attire must be finger-tip length while standing and must allow for stooping, bending, and sitting modestly. The appropriate length must be evident in the front and back;
 - b. Muscle shirts, mesh/transparent tops, or low-cut tops are not permitted;
 - c. Shirts should be long enough that, at all times, they meet the top of the pants or skirt or shorts so that midriff, lower back, and/or underwear are not exposed;
 - d. Halters, strapless attire (including off-the shoulder), and spaghetti straps are prohibited; Clothing may not have holes, cuts, slits, rips, or tears that expose or nearly expose underwear or skin above fingertip length.
- 6) Waistbands must be worn at the waist (no sagging pants);

On the weekends, dress code regulations are loosened. Students are still expected to dress appropriately and with respect to the school.

The following standards must be followed during non-academic days:

- 1) Appropriate undergarments must be worn and should not be visible; and students should not go shirtless;
- 2) Footwear must be worn when outside the residence hall room;
- 3) Clothing may not contain slogans or images which are considered profane or vulgar, or promote tobacco products, alcohol, drugs, or gang affiliation, or considered insensitive to race, religion, sexual orientation, ethnicity or gender;
- 4) Clothing must provide adequate covering:
 - a. Skirts, dresses, shorts, or similar attire must allow for stooping, bending, and sitting modestly. They must opaquely cover undergarments and private parts at all times;
 - b. Shirts should be long enough that undergarments are covered at all times;
 - c. Clothing may not have holes, cuts, slits, rips, or tears that expose or nearly expose underwear.
- 5) Waistbands must be worn at the waist (no sagging pants);

Clothing, wigs, face paint and other items of attire that could be classified as “costumes” are not appropriate for general school wear, unless being worn during a school-approved day and/or activity. The other dress code guidelines shall still be followed.